

6.5.5 Preparation of Dissertation

We intentionally leave room for individual variation when producing a project dissertation but there are, however, a number of conventions which you should follow:

- 1 The format of the title page of the dissertation should be as follows (spaced out with blank lines as appropriate):

University of Southampton

Faculty of Engineering and Physical Sciences

Electronics and Computer Science

<title>

by

<name>

<date of completion>

Supervisor: <Supervisor>

Second Examiner: <Second Examiner>

A dissertation submitted in partial fulfilment of the degree

of MSc <degree title>

- 2 The front cover should be followed by the following pages:
 - a. Abstract: an abstract giving a summary of the dissertation, not exceeding six hundred words.

- b. Acknowledgements (as appropriate).
 - c. Statement of Originality: A Statement of Originality must be included and should follow the Abstract on a separate page. The form of this statement is prescribed in the [ECS Statement of Originality Template](#) (a word version of this is available [here](#)).
 - d. Table of Contents: a list of all chapters, appendices and bibliography.
 - e. You may also include a List of Figures, figure by figure, where each listed item has a reference number. However, this is not required.
 - f. Main body of the dissertation.
 - g. References: The body of the report should be followed by references.
 - h. Appendix: The appendices, if any, come at the end of the report.
- 3 Students should ensure that they have discussed the format and structure of their thesis with their supervisor.
- 4 The body of the dissertation must not exceed 15,000 words. The entire dissertation (including the front pages, bibliography and appendices) should not normally exceed 50 pages.
- 5 Students who feel they require further guidance are advised to look at MSc dissertations produced by previous students.